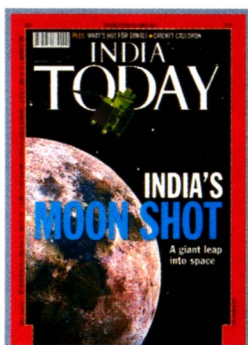


India's Moon Shot

NOVEMBER 3, 2008

With its lunar mission blasting off from Sriharikota, India takes a giant leap towards planetary exploration and even manned space flights.



“The much-awaited moon mission is a great lift for India. This would certainly create a surge in job opportunities in the space sector. But other development issues like global warming, disaster warning system etc must not be ignored.”

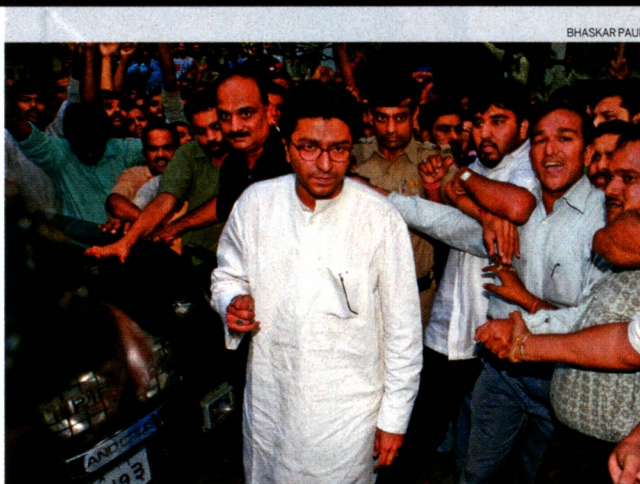
AMRIT KUMAR MOHANTY, *on e-mail*

Moonstruck

Kudos to the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) for giving the nation the finest Diwali gift, Chandrayaan-1, and putting India in the list of spacefaring nations. After this, ISRO should work closely to develop our security system. It should focus its time, energy and money on developing an infrared remote-sensing satellite to keep an eye on our enemies across the border and terrorist movements, particularly at high altitudes.

BIDYUT KUMAR CHATTERJEE,
Faridabad

Despite constraints and limited resources, India's scientific community has been able to prove its mettle. They could not only dare to wish for the moon but get it as well with their



Divide, and Hope to Rule

The Thackerays, the first family of politics in Maharashtra, consider themselves self-proclaimed custodians of Maratha pride (“Bully by the Horns”, November 3). It is their unsaid duty to do whatever they can to protect the rights of millions of Maharashtrians, and often they resort to unlawful means, which is not right.

SHIV SHANKER ALMAL, *on e-mail*

The Congress and NCP are under the illusion that dividing Shiv Sena's votebank will fetch them rich rewards, but the politics of convenience will divide the nation instead.

BAL GOVIND, *on e-mail*

ambitious lunar missions. The team of scientists at ISRO deserves rich accolades for having overcome difficulties over resources by pooling with six developed nations. Besides reviving the global interest in lunar expeditions, they have also broken away from the shackles of being a third world nation to be at the helm of a path-breaking lunar mission that is all set to provide the world with the most comprehensive digital map of the moon—which is hitherto unprecedented in the planet.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
on e-mail

Chandrayaan-1 is too expensive an ego trip for a nation that is being plagued with starvation deaths and farmer suicides. Spending Rs 386

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